

PART 1: INTRODUCTION

What The D&D® Game Is All About

DUNGEONS & DRAGONS® Fantasy Adventure Game ("D&D® Game" for short) is a role playing adventure game for persons 10 years and older. In the D&D rules, individuals play the role of characters in a fantasy world where magic is real and heroes venture out on dangerous quests in search of fame and fortune. Characters gain experience by overcoming perils and recovering treasures. As characters gain experience, they grow in power and ability.

At least two persons are needed to play this game, though the game is most enjoyable when played by a group of four to eight people. This game, unlike others, does not use a playing board or actual playing pieces. All that is needed to play are these rules, the dice included in this set, pencil and paper, graph paper, and imagination. The game may be more exciting if miniature lead figures of the characters and monsters are used, but the game can be played without such aids.

How To Use This Book

This book contains all the basic rules necessary to play DUNGEONS & DRAGONS® Fantasy Adventure Game. It has been organized into eight parts.

Part one, the **INTRODUCTION**, explains general background information and defines many of the terms used. These and other terms are collected and defined in the **GLOSSARY** (in the back of the book).

Part two, **PLAYER CHARACTER INFORMATION**, explains how to create a player character and is arranged in numbered, easy to follow steps.

Part three, **SPELLS**, lists magic-user, elf, and clerical spells along with a description and notes on the use of each spell.

Part four, **THE ADVENTURE**, is filled with general information useful to all the players.

Most of the action in D&D games take place during encounters, so Part five, **THE ENCOUNTER**, deals with these actions, including **COMBAT**.

Part six, **MONSTERS**, contains descriptions and explanations of over 100 monsters, arranged alphabetically.

Part seven, **TREASURE**, explains the different types of treasure and many magical items which the player characters may find during their adventures.

Part eight, **DUNGEON MASTER INFORMATION**, gives a step-by-step design of a sample dungeon level plus tips to help the referee.

This rule booklet deals mostly with adventure in a dungeon and explains the different player character classes (professions) from the 1st to the 3rd level of experience. (These and other terms will be explained later in this booklet.) The **D&D® EXPERT SET** adds to these rules, providing further details for player character classes from the 4th to the 14th level of experience, and gives rules for adventuring in the wilderness outside of the dungeons. A supplement — the **D&D® COMPANION SET** — provides further details for player character classes from the 15th to the 36th level of experience.

Each rule booklet is drilled with holes, so that if desired, the pages may be cut apart and rearranged in a ring binder. To cut the pages apart either scissors or a razor knife and a ruler may be used.

Whenever possible, the other rule booklets will be divided into the same eight parts to make them easy to combine into one larger set of rules. Every page of the D&D BASIC rules are numbered "B#", and each page also lists the section it is from.

Read the whole book through (except for the sample dungeon). D&D rules all fit together, and rules that seem confusing at first will become more understandable when used with the rest of the game. This is not like any other game you've ever played before: it is more important that you understand the ideas in the rules than that you know every detail about the game. When you understand how they work, the rules will become more understandable.

While the material in this booklet is referred to as rules, that is not really correct. Anything in this booklet (and other D&D booklets) should be thought of as changeable — anything, that is, that the Dungeon Master or referee thinks should be changed. This is not to say that everything in this booklet should be discarded! All of this material has been carefully thought out and playtested. However, if, after playing the rules as written for a while, you or your referee (the **Dungeon Master**) think that something should be changed, first think about how the changes will affect the game, and then go ahead. The purpose of these "rules" is to provide **guidelines** that enable you to play and have fun, so don't feel absolutely bound to them.

Definitions of Standard D&D® Terms

READ THIS SECTION CAREFULLY. These terms will be used throughout the rest of this booklet; they are also in the **GLOSSARY** at the end of this booklet. When a group plays a D&D game, one person acts as a referee and is known as the **Dungeon Master (DM)**. Others play the roles of fantasy characters and are called the **players**. Each player's character is called a **player character (PC)**. Other characters met in the game, who are controlled by the DM, are called **non-player characters (NPCs)**. A group of characters (PC and NPC) who travel together is called a **party**.

It is the DM's job to prepare the setting for each adventure before the game begins. This setting is called a **dungeon** since most adventures take place in underground caverns or stone rooms beneath old ruins or castles. The dungeon is carefully mapped on paper (usually graph paper). A dungeon may be designed by the DM, or may be a purchased dungeon, such as the one included in this set (called a **dungeon module**). Whether creating a new dungeon or carefully studying a module, the DM must be willing to spend more time in preparation than the players. The DM's job takes the most time, but it is also the most creative and rewarding.

The players will create characters by following the instructions given in Part 2, **PLAYER CHARACTER INFORMATION**. Each player will choose a **class** (profession) for their characters. The classes are chosen by looking carefully at the abilities of each character. When the DM has prepared a dungeon and the players have created their characters, the game is ready to begin.

Each game session is called an **adventure**. An adventure lasts for as long as the players and the DM agree to play. An adventure begins when the party enters a dungeon, and ends when the party has left the dungeon and divided up treasure. An adventure may run for only an hour, or it might fill an entire weekend! The amount of playing time depends on the desires of the players and the DM. Several related adventures (one adventure leading to another, often with the same player characters) is called a **campaign**.